

VHSL CHEER TECHNICAL OFFICIAL CHEAT SHEET

BRIEF DESCRIPTION		RULE	PAGE	EXPLANATION
Most Common Deductions:				
	BASKET/CRADLE CAUGHT INVERTED	2.5.2b	26	top person must not land in an inverted position
	DIVE ROLLS	2.8.3	32	not permitted; dive roll definition: feet at or above waist before hands make contact with floor [page 12]
	DROPS FROM JUMPS	2.9.1	33	weight first borne on hands/feet or descent is controlled
	HAIR/BOW FALLS OFF	1.1.5	7	hair must be worn appropriate for activity; bow must SECURELY FASTENED to not increase risk
	INATTENTIVE SPOTTER	2.2.5	16	appropriate position to minimize risk to flyer, remain visually focused on head/neck/shoulders, in position w/ quickest path to protect flyer in a fall
	JEWELRY	2.1.1	15	no jewelry (except religious medal w/o chain taped inside uniform or medical alert worn & taped anywhere)
	NAILS	1.1.4	7	nails must be short, near end of fingers
	RELEASE FROM PREP TO PRONE/FLATBACK	2.5.6e	27	still prohibited from extended; can be legal from prep if release isn't significantly higher than point of contact with bases
	PROPS: DISCARDING SIGNS	2.10.1	34	hard props must be gently tossed/placed; not directly from flyer to floor; cannot toss to each other
	PROPS: STEP ON DURING STUNT/SKILL	2.10.3	34	cannot step on prop while spotting, stunting, or during landing from jump or tumbling skill; transitioning and stepping on is ok
	SINGLE BASE PREP NEEDS SPOTTER	2.2.8	17	spotter required when flyer's feet are in single base's hands; spotter can grasp under foot (to become double based prep w/o spotter)
	SPOTTER HAND PLACEMENT	2.2.6	16	if spotter is required, spotter cannot grasp under flyer's foot or on bases' hands under flyer's foot
Other Deductions:				
1.1 General Risk	CANDY/GUM	1.1.9	8	must not chew gum/candy while performing
	CAST/BRACE (HARD VS. SOFT)	1.1.11	8	soft/non-abrasive/non-hardening = no extra padding needed; hard/unyielding needs approved foam cover
	CAST/BRACE ON LOWER BODY	1.1.11	8	must be unaltered; boot/plaster cast = no stunts, pyramid, tosses, jumps, tumbling
	CAST/BRACE ON UPPER BODY	1.1.11	8	must be unaltered; soft or covered in approved foam if hard and doing skills
2.1	APPAREL/ACCESSORIES	2.1.2	15	appropriate for activity; must wear athletic shoes
	GLITTER	2.1.5	15	glitter that doesn't readily adhere is not permitted
2.2 Stunt Personnel	PROPS: BASES WITH SHARED POMS	2.2.1b/c	16	base and flyer may only share a pom during mount/dismount @ prep or below; no shared props in extended stunts
	OVER/UNDER PARTNER STUNT	2.2.10	17	athletes must not move over/under stunts unless helping build, stabilize, or dismount; T-lift over nugget is allowed - nugget must be head down
	SPOTTER REQUIRED IN EXTENDED STUNTS	2.2.4/7	16	can help build/support but not provide primary support; required for ext stunts (check list of exceptions - single base vertical stunt supported @ waist)
	STUNT HEIGHT LIMIT	2.2.9	17	≤2 level w/ flyer weight supported by bases in direct contact w/ mat
2.3 Inversions	BRACED FLIP IN PYRAMID	2.3.5	19	3 people involved in toss; continuous contact w/ 1+ bracer (hand to hand/arm or hand to foot/feet); bracer in prep w/ spotter; flyer must be to side/front of bracer, end non-inverted, with ≤: 1¼ flip, 1 twist, and ¼ turn around bracer
	BRACED FLIP: STATIONARY BRACER	2.3.5c/d	19	flip bracers must be in stationary prep w/ spotter; if flip to cradle, horizontal @ prep or below , or floor, bracer can release or go to load during descent
	BRACED FLIP: ADD'L NON HAND/ARM	2.3.5e	19	when hand to hand/arm contact established elsewhere ; must be @ prep or below; if prep/shoulder stand, must have 2 bases or base + spotter
	BRACED FLIP: HAND TO FOOT ONLY	2.3.5k	19	if hand to foot/feet is only connection - no twists, must be in prep w/ spotter, must go to original bases
	CHORUS LINE FLIP	2.3.6	20	no limit to number of performers [see situation D on page 22]
	INVERSION AT EXTENDED	2.3.2	19	may pass thru extended but cannot begin, end or stop/pause @ extended
	INVERSION BELOW PREP	2.3.6b	20	requires 1 person to maintain contact until no longer inverted or flyer hands on floor
	INVERSION PREP & ABOVE	2.3.6c2	20	2 people must protect head/neck, maintain contact with 1+, contact maintained until no longer inverted; foldover "pancake" is exception
	INVERSION FOLDOVER/PANCAKE	2.3.6c2	20	must start from prep/below; flyer caught on back by multiple bases; if not original, be in place prior to start
	INVERSION INTO STUNT	2.3.9	20	athletes must not leave floor unassisted without hands with intent to land or be caught inverted in a stunt
	INVERSION MAY RELEASE TO...	2.3.6a 1-3	20	non inverted dismount, load or stunt at any level w/ ≤1 twist; requires spotter & original bases
	INVERSION TO SURFACE	2.3.6c3	20	must not go directly from upright vertical at prep or higher to inverted on surface
2.4	INVERSION WITH PROPS	2.3.7	20	no props while inverted except: prone dismount to fwd roll, inversion on floor to non-inverted stunt, assisted walkover, partner cartwheel
	BRACED EXTENDED STUNTS	2.4.1	24	flyer & bracer connection must not be hand/arm to foot/leg if both are extended
	NON-RELEASE TO HORIZONTAL/CRADLE	2.4.2	24	if flyer is moved from vertical to horizontal/cradle with new bases - must be in place before initiation of skill/doing nothing else/remain close to original bases
2.5 Release Stunts	BRACERS (RELEASE TRANSITIONS)	2.5.5b/d/g	26	bracer @ prep or below; prep/shoulder stand req. 2 bases or base + spotter; release ≤¼ turn around bracer; cannot pass over torso of another flyer/bracer
	HELICOPTER	2.5.7	27	≤180°, no twist, face up, 3 bases; tosser/catcher in place throughout
	PROPS DURING TOSS/BASKET	2.5.3e	26	no objects in hands of flyers during toss
	QUICK TOSS	2.5.9	27	considered release not actual toss; permitted
	RELEASE STUNTS	2.5.2	26	directed vertical to original bases who remain stationary; can't land inverted; no over/under person or prop; ≤1¼ twist; no contact with other released flyer
	RELEASE: BRACED TO NEW CATCHERS	2.5.5e	26	must be in place before initiation of skill/doing nothing else/remain close to original bases
	RELEASE: NON BRACED SEATED/PIKE	2.5.6f	27	seated/pike can release to stunt at any level but may not twist then land back in seated/pike position
	RELEASE: NON-BRACED HORIZONTAL	2.5.6g	27	cradle/horizontal @ prep or below can release to original bases in any stunt/load @ any level/turn
	RELEASE: NON-BRACED VERTICAL	2.5.6c/d	27	ok to original bases; upper body remains vertical when starting from ext; full twist allowed when going extended to extended
	TOE/THIGH PITCH	2.5.8	27	not permitted to jump or tumble skill
2.6 Suspended Stunts	TOSSES AS RELEASE FROM BELOW PREP LEVEL	2.5.4	26	any release of feet from below prep = toss; must be caught non-inverted by original bases; cannot toss significantly higher than landing; ball up position only
	TOSSES TO CRADLE	2.5.3	26	≤4 tossers incl. 1 behind head throughout; must have 3+ original catchers incl. 1 behind head; no hip-over-head rotation allowed
	BRACED SPLITS	2.6.3	29	2+ bases; one must maintain contact
	SUSPENDED SPLITS (NON-BRACED @ EXT)	2.6.2	29	extended requires 3+ bases, 2 under legs, both flyer's hands in contact @ full split
2.7 Dismounts	SUSPENDED SPLITS (NON-BRACED @ PREP)	2.6.1	29	below prep requires 2+ bases, contact w/ both flyer's hands
	SWINGING STUNT	2.6.5	29	ok w/ down movement & stunt below prep, flyer face up & begins on mat or below prep level
	DISMOUNTS TO NEW BASES	2.7.8	31	2 catchers + spotter who are not in other choreo at time of release; flyer no skill after release (1/4 twist is exception)
	DISMOUNTS TO SURFACE	2.7.2	30	prep level/above require physical assistance to slow momentum, no physical spotter required
2.8 Tumbling	PROPS: CRADLE WITH SIGNS	2.7.3b	30	flyer must not hold props with hard materials/corners/sharp edges in cradles
	TWIST DISMOUNT TO CRADLE/SURFACE	2.7.7	31	no more than 1¼ rotations
	KIP UPS	2.8.7	32	must not go airborne first. cannot involve jumping from standing or squatting backwards onto head/neck
	HEADSTANDS/SPINS/SPRINGS	2.8.8/9	32	must use hands to support; must not connect to other athletes when airborne
	TUMBLING OVER/UNDER STUNT/ATHLETE	2.8.1	32	not permitted except for non-airborne over person/prop on mat
	TUMBLING WITH PROPS	2.8.2	32	allowed in fwd/bckwd rolls; soft props allowed when hands not in use
BOLD & UNDERLINED ARE NEW FOR 2026-2027				

NFHS Spirit Rules Changes 2026-2027

Definitions in Rules 2 and 3:

Revised definition of loading position/load.

Revised definition of tumbling.

2-3-5a and **(new) k**: New language added to allow a flipping inversion when the top person and bracer have only a hand-to-foot connection. Additionally, when a hand-to-foot connection is the only connection, new restrictions have been added.

2-3-5d: New language added to allow a bracer to release the top person or move to a load position during a flip inversion when the top person is descending and goes to a cradle, a horizontal position or the performance surface.

2-4-2c and **3-4-3c**: New language added to clarify criteria for new catchers during releases from a vertical to horizontal position.

2-5-5g (new): New language added to codify that a top person is prohibited from passing over another top person or bracer during stunts.

2-5-6c: New language added to allow a single twist during a vertical release from an extended position to an extended position.

2-5-6e: New language added to clarify that two catchers are required for releases from a vertical to a horizontal position.

2-7-8d and **3-7-8d**: New language added to allow a $\frac{1}{4}$ twist during a cradle dismount to new catchers.